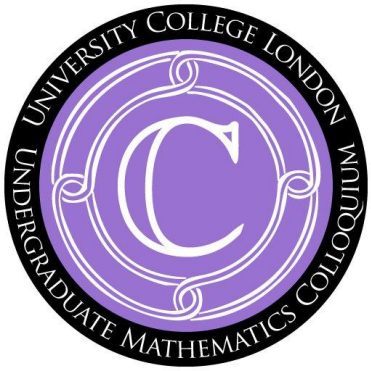


UCL Undergraduate Mathematics Colloquium

Homepage: `https://ucl-ug-col.github.io`

Instagram: `https://www.instagram.com/ucl.umc`

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E-mail: `uclugmathcol@gmail.com`

Date: **14thth October** 2026, Time: **2-3.30pm**

Location: **Room 706, Mathematics Department**

The Computer Becomes a Weapon

Speaker: **Dr Troy Kaighin Astarte** (Swansea University)

Abstract: What was the first computer? Some candidate answers jump to mind, but a few minutes' careful thinking reveals the question is very poorly phrased. In this talk, we will consider why that is the case and begin to disentangle some early aspects of the history of the things we now call 'computers'. In doing so, we will find ourselves confronting very quickly their militaristic origins, and some even darker ones. We will review the conditions in which modern computers were developed and consider what kind of legacies they might leave. Along the way, we might even find ourselves thinking about how these histories are echoed in current debates about technology. Yes, I wrote "we" throughout, in recognition of what I hope to be a discussion as a group as well as a lecture.